



Types of automated testing tools 10m

Testing tools help testers perform effective testing while minimising the time required and eliminating repetitive tasks.

There are many software testing tools available, both open-source and commercial.

Software testing tools can be broadly categorised by the testing activity they support:

- Test management – to organise the end-to-end test cycle, including bug tracking
- Functional testing – useful for repeated regression testing
- Nonfunctional testing – for performance testing, load testing, security testing and so on.

Some common testing tools are listed below.

[Skip to main content](#)

Test activity supported by tool	Examples of tools	Purpose of tools
Test management tools	■ qTest ■ Testpad ■ TestRail ■ Zephyr ■ OpenText AQM ■ MantisBT ■ Jira	■ Tracking requirements ■ Testing coverage ■ Traceability ■ Completing test environments expected to be in place ■ Maintaining test cases ■ Scheduling and status of tests ■ Tracking test cases ■ Defect tracking ■ Test reporting
Functional testing	■ Tricentis ■ Selenium ■ OpenText Functional Testing ■ SoapUI ■ Cucumber	■ Web-based applications testing ■ Client/server applications testing ■ Cross-browser testing ■ Mobile testing ■ API testing
Nonfunctional testing	■ OpenText Professional Performance Engineering (LoadRunner Professional) ■ JMeter ■ ReadyAPI ■ NeoLoad	■ Performance testing ■ Load testing ■ Security testing

Selecting the right automation tool

There are many tools available to support testing at each stage of development. Some tools require a paid licence, while others are free.

[Skip to main content](#)

Often, free or open-source tools have less support than commercial or licensed tools – perhaps just a chat room where fellow users can compare issues. So, you'll need to ~~consider this when selecting your tools.~~

Not all tools cover all permutations. Some tools perform a specific and limited function, so, you'll likely need to use more than one tool.

This is known as providing a point solution – solving a particular problem without regard to other related issues.

Tools that integrate from an end-to-end perspective are ideal as they give full project traceability and support any delivery method. You need to understand what type of services are being provided and determine what tools are the right fit for the project.

Dig deeper

Here are some suggested automation testing tools for you to try. Take a look at these three examples:

- Have a trial run at testing an application using Tosca. This gives you a free 14-day download of the tool and four sample vehicle insurance web applications to test.
- Selenium is a free, open-source automated testing suite for web applications across different browsers and platforms. It supports various operating systems and mobile devices. Tests can be executed in parallel while the browser is minimised. Its disadvantages are that it can only test web applications, can't access elements outside the web application (such as address bar or back and forward buttons) and can't generate test or bug reports.
- Explore and install Cucumber. It's a useful tool for acceptance testing.

Here are some options for further exploration:

- Take a look at this example of how to create a Webdriver script (Rungta, 2025) using Selenium.

[Skip to main content](#)



Thoughts on this page?

